



Air Quality Situation Report

Edmonton Folk Music Festival ·
Gallagher Park

Sat, Aug 1, 2026 · 12:12 AM MDT
For more information, contact Gary Redmond, ACA Executive Director at 780.935.4279

Air Quality Health Index (AQHI) — Edmonton

3.0

Current AQHI at Edmonton McCauley (1.66 km from venue)
Forecast Sat 1:00 AM: 2.5

Health Risk	AQHI	At-Risk Population	General Population
Low Risk	3.0	Enjoy your usual outdoor activities.	Ideal air quality for outdoor activities.

No active Environment Canada weather alerts for the venue.

Environmental Intelligence Summary

- At Edmonton Folk Music Festival, temperature is 19.4°C and feels near 20.4°C. Winds are 8 km/h from SE, gusting near 16 km/h.
- The nearest current AQHI is 3 at Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km from the venue.
- A gridded AQHI estimate blending official and community sensors (confidence: High) puts the area near 2.
- The nearest air monitoring station (Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km) reports fine particulate matter (PM2.5) at 18.1 µg/m³.
- An on-site community sensor ('ACA_CloverdaleCL', 0.5 km) reads 17.6 µg/m³ PM2.5.
- Back-trajectory modeling (HRDPS wind fields, 6 h lookback) indicates the air currently at the venue traveled from the vicinity of a point 90.3 km to the SW, i.e. arriving from the SW.
- The nearest active fire detection (NASA FIRMS – VIIRS, last 2026-07-31) is 6.2 km E of the venue. The modeled back-trajectory passes within 6.2 km of this fire, making smoke transport to the venue plausible based on wind-field modeling.
- The AQHI forecast for Sat 1:00 AM is 2.
- Thunderstorm conditions appear in the hourly forecast beginning around Sat 11:00 PM.
- Overall operational environmental risk is HIGH. Primary concerns are heat, precipitation, thunderstorm.

Recommendations

- Confirm lightning monitoring, shelter, pause and evacuation procedures.
- Increase hydration, shade, cooling and heat-illness messaging.
- Prepare drainage, electrical protection and wet-weather controls.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — general population: Ideal air quality for outdoor activities.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — at-risk populations: Enjoy your usual outdoor activities.

Hazard Snapshot — Overall Risk: High Risk

AIR QUALITY Low Risk 3.0 AQHI	HEAT High Risk 31.9 °C apparent/humidex	WIND Low Risk 31.0 km/h peak gust	PRECIPITATION High Risk 1.0 mm/h maximum	THUNDERSTORM High Risk Sat 11:00 PM first forecast signal
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Local Monitoring

Nearest station 3.0 Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km	Blended estimate 2.0 confidence High	PM2.5 (station) 18.1 µg/m³ Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km	PM2.5 (community) 17.6 µg/m³ ACA_CloverdaleCL · 0.45 km
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Prepared by Alberta Capital Airshed for the Edmonton Folk Music Festival. Beta decision-support product — for the interactive map, live cameras and hourly outlook, scan the QR code or visit https://dkevinm.github.io/environmental_intelligence_edmonton/

